

conversions, flight booking, frequent flier management, changes in schedules, hotel stay, and when you get the time, a little sightseeing as well.

Your needs from an augmented system are very different from, say, someone who does a lot of travelling inside a city, has to find new businesses/clients, grab quick and cheap bites to eat while on the go, and be on top of the weather and traffic conditions in the city so as to make the most of the limited hours in the day.

Currently, you have to do all the searching and finding out and ask all the right questions, even though all of the necessary answers are already out there. They're just masked behind different systems, different data sets, and different proprietary constraints. You can get multiple apps to do each of those tasks, but you can't yet get an experience tailored to you that could perhaps use the databases and services of multiple apps and just provide you with a single, simple, seamless interface.

This is what we mean by "tying it all up", and it will happen, by mergers and buyouts, or by interesting new revenue sharing models, but it will happen. How are we so sure? Because it's what we need and want, and are willing to pay for. If you're willing to pay for something, once there are enough of people like you, someone will be make that something to help part you and your money. That's just how the world works...

### APPLICATIONS

It's easy to slot AR into a nice niche for the travellers, or outdoorsy types who love gimmicks. Look at the examples we've given thus far, it seems like all the apps available are for that purpose - find your way, what's here, sell you stuff, etc.

That's only what's available now, when it's just starting to be adopted. Imagine when everyone has a phone powerful enough to show 3D graphics overlaid on what's shown on the camera, or when everyone has a heads-up display (HUD) in order to interface with technology. That's when everything really becomes possible. So what's this future going to look like? Let's take a look.

### MIXED REALITY

To start of, first let's understand the concept of what some people call mixed



A wonderful experience, no doubt, but not something you want to wear outside

reality. This is because in the strictest of terms, a lot of the apps and applications you are likely to come across have both AR and VR. Take for example an app that shows you data about the monument in front of you. If it has labels and just simple data overlaid on the visual of the monument, then it's just augmenting reality. However, if it starts showing you images of, say, Stonehenge, as we think it was thousands of years ago, and plays a video of druids chanting in front of new looking stones, then that's delving into virtual reality's domain. In this issue itself you will find a puzzle that you can solve just by scanning a picture jumble, and that's, well mixed reality... Basically what we've been calling "enhanced reality" or reality+ all this time.

The only reason we mention this, is to avoid getting angry letters about the example usages of "AR" that follow, saying "How can you call that AR, that's VR." Since everyone has their own definitions, ours is, if it's overlaid on something you're experiencing in real

life, it's AR / ER (enhanced reality), and if it's imaginary, like a game or experiencing deep sea diving while sitting in a chair, it's VR. Savvy?

### ADVERTISING

It's a necessary evil, and without it, most technologies would cost way more than they do now. Actually, most anything would cost way more than it does now, including this magazine you hold in your hands, without advertising spends to subsidise it all. For one thing, there'd be no "free" apps without advertising, and you can expect this to continue.

Enhanced reality will depend heavily on advertising; you can count on this. What this means is that every aspect that we mention hereafter will also have an advertising angle to it. You will be coaxed into buying new things in ever-increasing new ways, but now the advertising will be way more contextual than either Google or Facebook can offer. For example, while walking in New York, not only will you be told where the Broadway theatres are, you will be told what's playing now, and also have an ad thrown up that says you get the cheapest tickets at xyz service (even if it's not true), and thus be enticed to buy a ticket right then and there.

That's not all, expect Minority Report style advertising - personalised and perhaps for your eyes and ears only, if you're wearing something like Google Glass in the future. With data gathering being everything, you can even expect customisation of ads to greater extents - so if you have a thing for people from the far east, all you will see in advertising is them, whilst someone else might only see dark skinned models trying to sell them things. The possibilities are endless, we just hope adblockers can keep up!



Remember the personalised advertising in Minority Report? It's where we're headed...